

Old Names of Countries

There are many such countries in the world that have had their names changed due to circumstances or time. ***Ghana** was the first country in Africa to gain its independence from British colonialism on 6th March, 1957. Its former name was Gold Coast. *The country of **Suriname** in South America was earlier known as Dutch Guiana. ***Zimbabwe** was formerly known as Southern Rhodesia. Earlier Zimbabwe was a British colony. The capital of Zimbabwe is Harare which was officially called Salisbury until 1982.

***Taiwan** was earlier known as Formosa. * Similarly **Myanmar** was known as Burma (or the Union of Burma), **Thailand** as Siam and **Iraq** as Mesopotamia.

Former Names of Countries/Regions	
Current Name	Old Name
Japan	Nippon
Iran	Persia
Lesotho	Basutoland
Ethiopia	Abyssinia
Botswana	Bechuanaland
Djibouti	French Somaliland
Zambia	Northern Rhodesia
Madagascar	Malagasy
Indonesia	Nusantara
Hawaii Island	Sandwich Island
Malawi	Nyasaland
Netherlands	Holland
Belize	British Honduras
Cambodia	Democratic Kampuchea
Zimbabwe	Southern Rhodesia
Democratic Republic of the Congo	Zaire
Malaysia	Federation of Malaya

1. Match List-I and List-II and choose the correct answer from the codes given below-

List-I (Old Name)	List-II (New Name)
A. Siam	1. Taiwan
B. Formosa	2. Myanmar
C. Mesopotamia	3. Thailand
D. Burma	4. Iraq

Code :

	A	B	C	D
(a)	2	1	3	4
(b)	4	2	1	3

(c) 1 3 2 4

(d) 3 1 4 2

Uttarakhand U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2003

Ans. (d)

The correct match of old names and new names is as follows

(New Name)	(Old Name)
Taiwan	- Formosa
Myanmar	- Burma (or Union of Burma)
Thailand	- Siam
Iraq	- Mesopotamia

2. Which of the following pairs is not correctly matched?

Current Name	Old Name
(a) Harare	- Salisbury
(b) Ethiopia	- Abyssinia
(c) Ghana	- Dutch Guiana
(d) Kinshasa	- Leopoldville

I.A.S. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (c)

Except for option (c) other pairs are correctly matched. The old name of Ghana is Gold Coast, not Dutch Guiana. Ghana was the first country on the African continent to achieve independence (on March 6, 1957) from the British colony. Dutch Guiana is known as Suriname.

3. Zimbabwe was earlier known as –

(a) Southern Rhodesia	(b) Gold Coast
(c) Ivory Coast	(d) Belgian Congo

U.P. Lower Sub. (Spl) (Pre) 2004

Ans. (a)

Zimbabwe was earlier known as Southern Rhodesia. It was a British colony. Harare, the capital of Zimbabwe, was previously known as Salisbury.

International Border Lines

*It is very important to know about the international boundary lines between major countries.

*The **Rio Grande** is one of the principal rivers in the United States and Mexico. It forms part of United States-Mexico border. ***Lake Victoria** of Africa also known as Lake Nyanza is the second largest freshwater lake in the world. The Lake's administrative rights are shared by three countries Kenya, Uganda and Tanzania. The lake thus creates an international border between Uganda-Tanzania, Uganda-Kenya and Kenya-Tanzania. * The **McMahon Line** is the effective boundary between India and China. India claims the